

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 3
 ♥ J 10 8 5
 ♦ K J
 ♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ A K 5

♥ A K 6

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 10 7 2

♥ Q 9 4

♦ Q 10 9

♣ J 10 7

♠ 9 6 4

♥ 7 3 2

♦ A 8 5 4 2

♣ 6 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

If the defenders can only take 2 ♠ tricks now you are home-free since dummy's 3 ♦s are now established.

You had to have the defender's ♠s split 4-3. But in fact you were pretty sure they were going to do so. Since East's ♠2 was probably his fourth-down then he couldn't have a fifth-down.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠2, West plays the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners and dummy's ♦ suit is your only hope. **IF** ♦s split 3-2 and **IF** the defenders don't take too many winners in their suit(s) you can establish ♦s by ducking twice.

Win the first ♠. If you hold up they might pocket the ♠ trick and switch to another suit where you only have two stoppers.

Next play a small ♦ from each hand. Win the return (probably a ♠) and duck a second ♦.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 4
 ♥ K 10 9 8 3
 ♦ J 5 3
 ♣ Q 3

♠ J 9 8
 ♥ A 6 5
 ♦ Q 10 9 6
 ♣ K 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 6 3
 ♥ Q J
 ♦ A K 4 2
 ♣ A 10 6 4

♠ Q 10 5 2
 ♥ 7 4 2
 ♦ 8 7
 ♣ J 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

West's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s. East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 5

Obviously you need to establish 4 ♥ winners and by driving out the ♥A you can manage that handily. The problem is that dummy has only one sure entry, (the ♠A), and the defenders may be good enough to hold up their ♥A twice.

To assure the contract you should win the first trick in your hand with the ♠K. Then play ♥Q, ♥J overtaking with dummy's ♥K so you can continue establishing the suit while you still have that ♠ entry.

None of the other suits were sitting well so overtaking the ♥ was the way to go.